



DESCRIPTIVE PARAGRAPHS

**Painting with Words: Crafting
Vivid Imagery in Writing**



THE POWER OF WORDS



Effective Descriptions

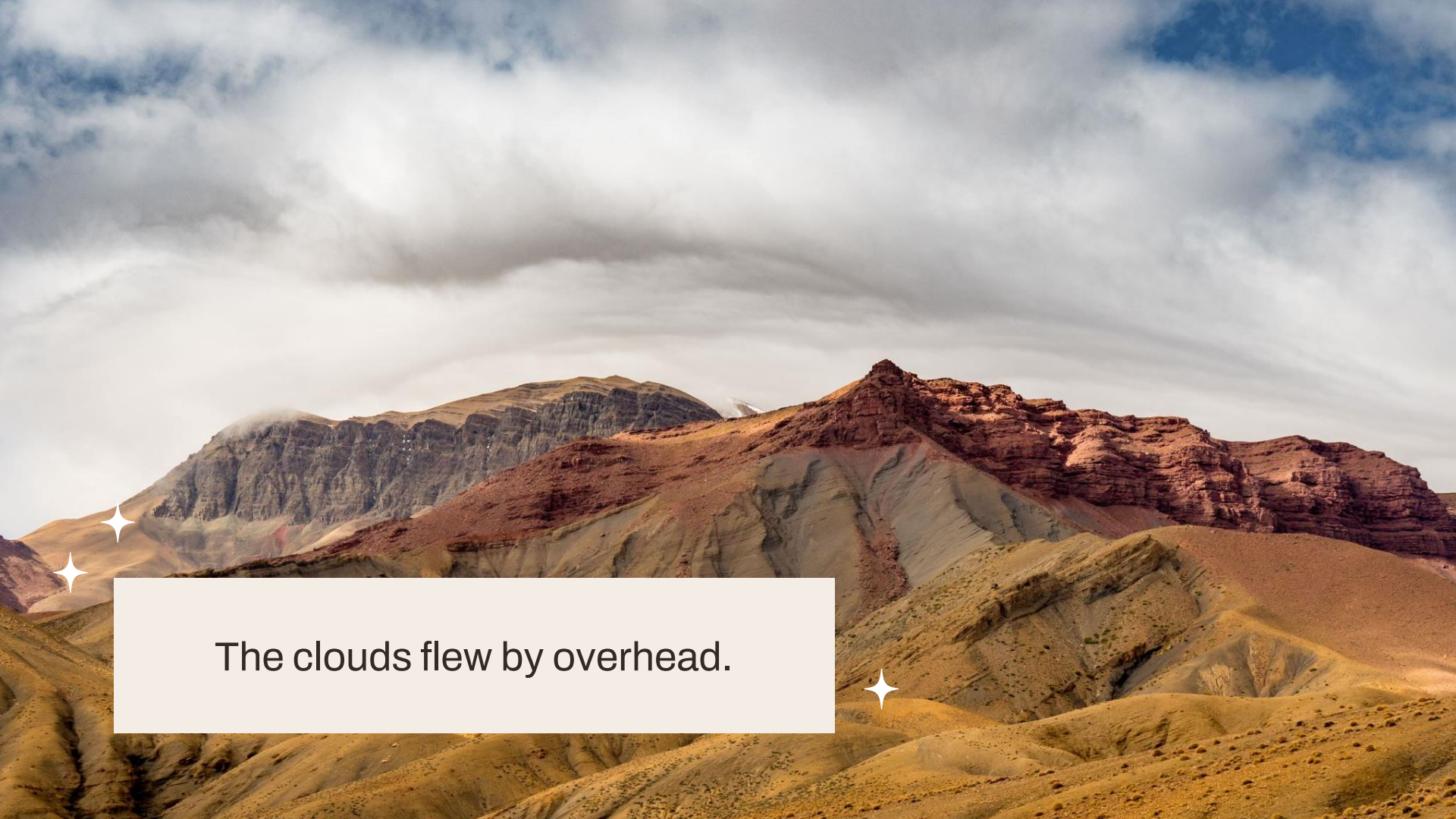
Creates images in the reader's
mind



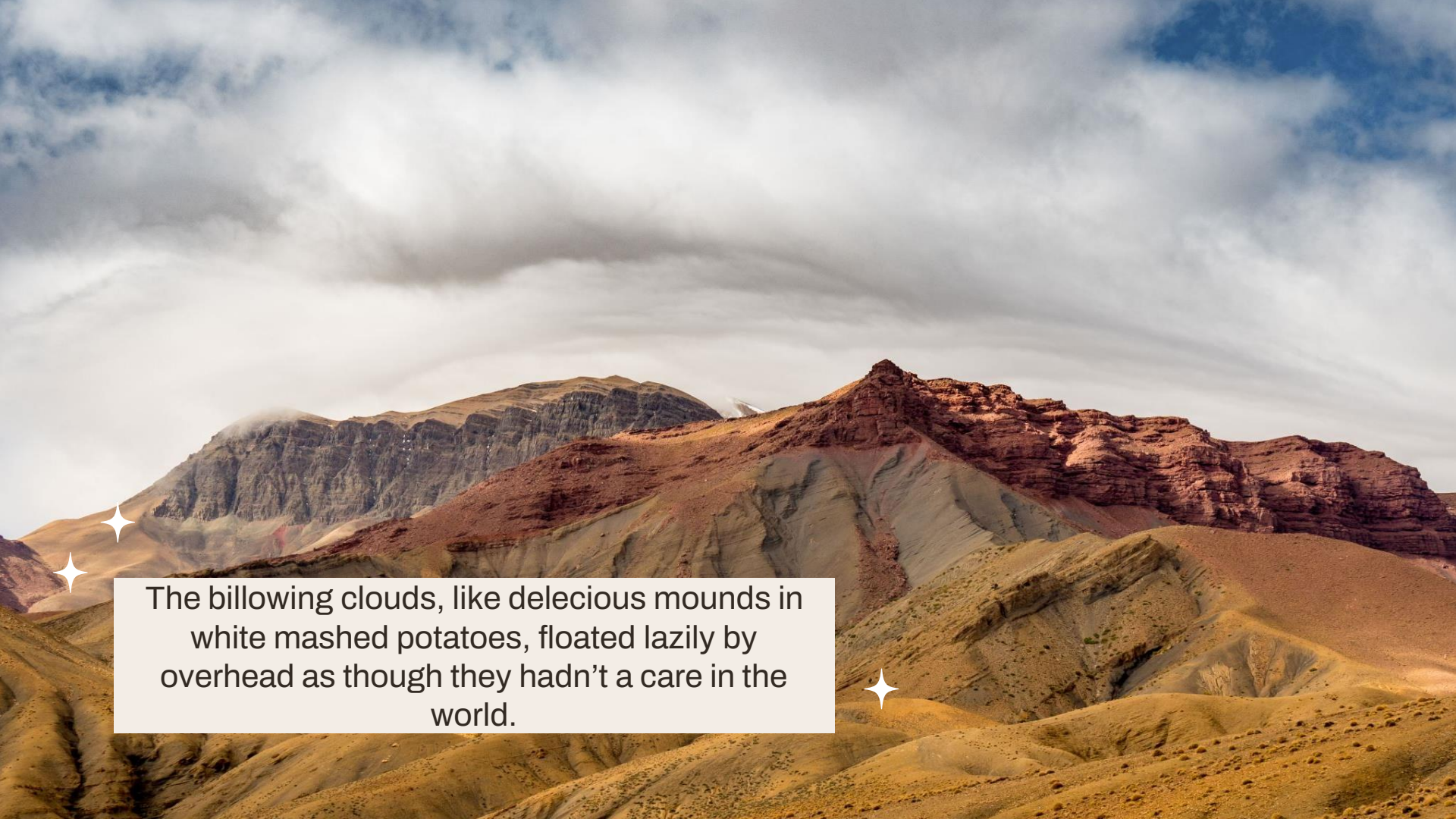
Use Specific Details

Readers are able to visualize
and feel





The clouds flew by overhead.

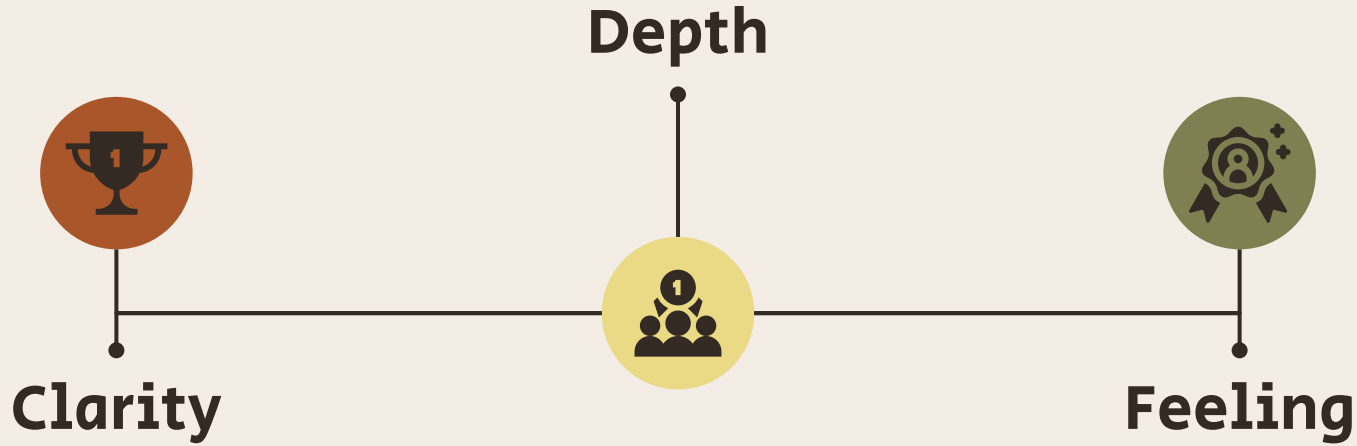
A wide-angle photograph of a mountain range. The foreground shows rolling hills with distinct horizontal geological layers in shades of tan, brown, and grey. In the background, a large, rugged mountain peak rises, its upper sections covered in snow and partially shrouded by thick, white, billowing clouds. The sky is filled with these clouds, with patches of blue visible at the top. The overall lighting suggests a late afternoon or early morning setting, with warm tones on the mountainsides.

✧ ✧ ✧

The billowing clouds, like delicious mounds in white mashed potatoes, floated lazily by overhead as though they hadn't a care in the world.

✧

Effective Description



Basics of Good Description

Main Impression

An overall feeling about the topic



Examples

Uses examples to support main impression



Details

Supports examples with details that appeal to the 5 senses



Living Words

Bring a person, place, or physical object to life for reader





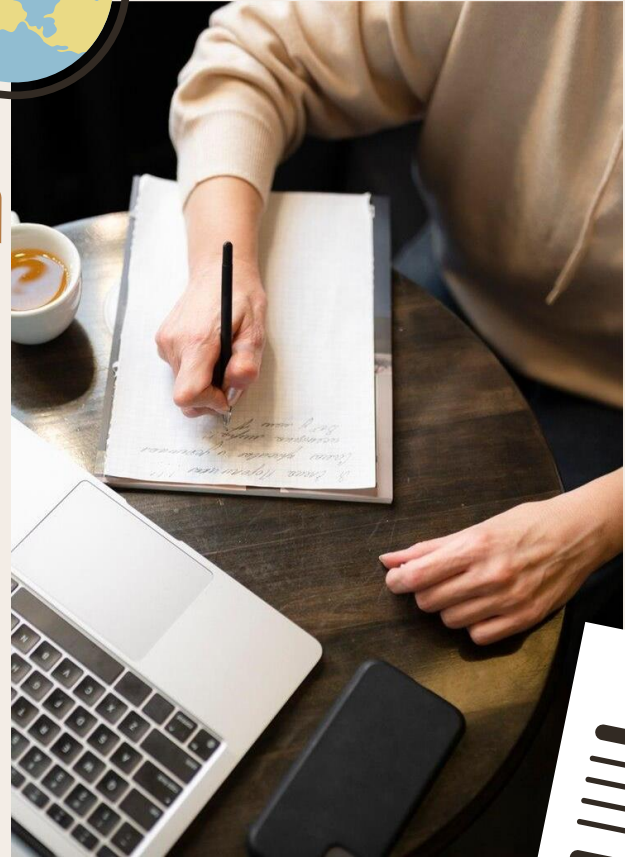
01

Types of Description

Objective and Subjective Descriptions

Objective Description

The snowman consisted of three round balls stacked on top of the other. It stood five feet high. Its eyes were round stones, with a carrot serving as a nose. A baseball cap sat atop its head.



Subjective Description

The snowman's body consisted of three plump balls of fluffy, white snow stacked like an ice-cream cone. Its eyes were made from brightly colored stones, with a squiggly, pigtail, orange carrot serving as a nose. A fuzzy, red knitted hat charmingly sat on top of his head.





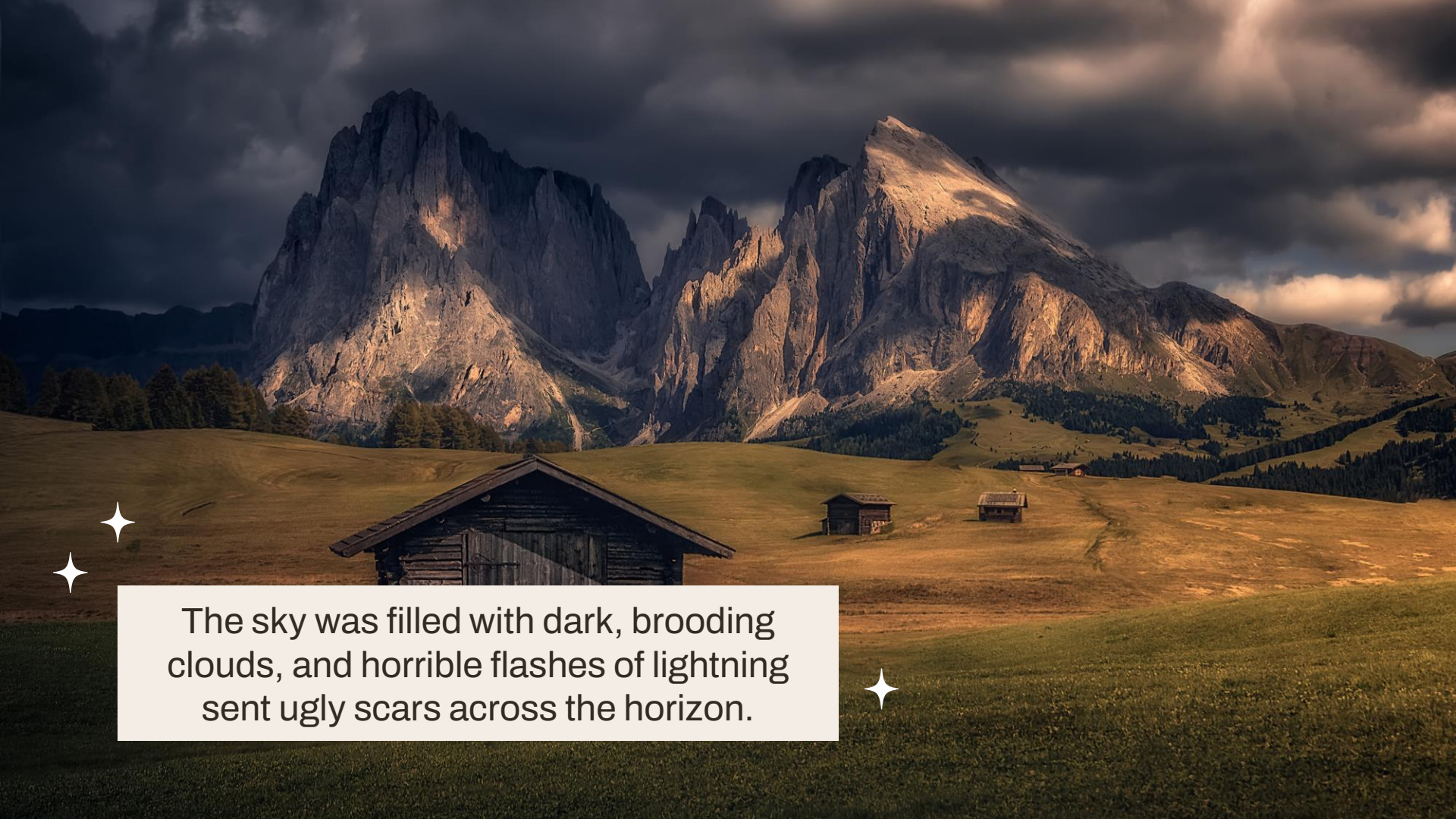
Dominant Impressions

Your descriptive writing will be clearer if you focus on one dominant impression.





The sky was filled with dark clouds.



✧ ✧

The sky was filled with dark, brooding clouds, and horrible flashes of lightning sent ugly scars across the horizon.

✧



What response/emotion do you
want readers to take away from
your description.

Provide specific details



Examples

01



It was spring in
Islamabad.

02



The cricket game was
played.

03



The diamond necklace lay
on the dresser.



Examples

01 _____

It was spring in
Islamabad.

01-A _____

Spring in Islamabad is one
the most rejuvenating
time of the year.

02 _____

The cricket game was
played.

02-A _____

The F1 Monaco race over
the weekend was
nailbiting which had us at
the edge of our seats.

03 _____

The diamond necklace lay
on the dresser.

03-A _____

The dazzling diamond
necklace with rubies and
emeralds was exquisite.



Activity

The haunted house was scary.

The thick woolen blanket felt nice.

My Uncle Jacob is fun.

Fiona's ballet practice was good.

The actors performance was bad.

The bands music was loud.

The dorm room was **messy**.

The aquarium decorations were **pretty**.

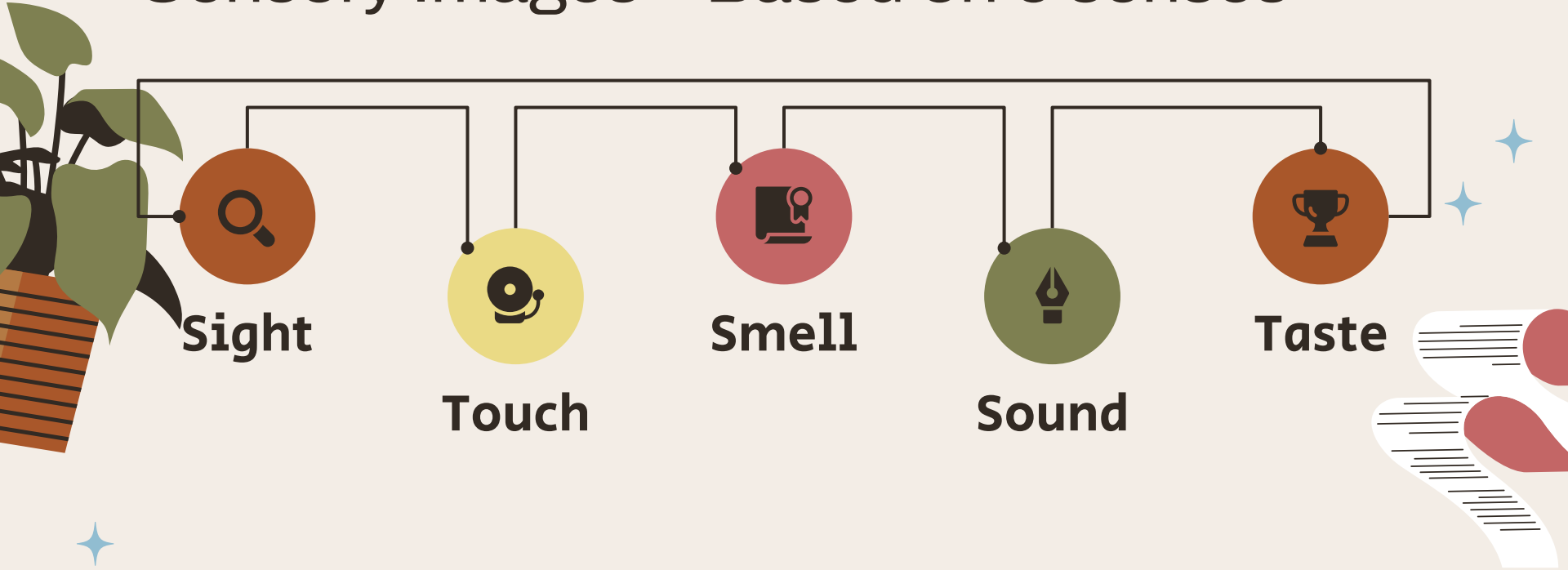
The chocolate mousse was **rich**.





SENSORY IMAGES

Sensory Images – Based on 5 senses



Descriptive & Nondescriptive



Sight-ND

The model walked
down the runway.



Touch-ND

The new bedsheets
were uncomfortable.



Descriptive & Nondescriptive



Sight-ND

The model walked down the runway.



Sight-Desc

The spaghetti thin fashion-model slinked down the long illuminous runway wearing a dazzling, cherry red dress.



Touch-ND

The new bedsheets were uncomfortable.



Touch-Desc

The new, stiff bedsheets felt like sandpaper scraping against my skin.





Rewrite the nondescriptive sentences by incorporating various sensory images.

Sight Details

The boy's clothes didn't fit properly.
The car was not in a good shape.

Touch Details (Texture)



The tree bark felt rough.
The baby's skin was soft.



Descriptive & Nondescriptive



Smell-ND

Fred's car trunk
smelled awful.



Sound-ND

The band was loud.



Descriptive & Nondescriptive



Smell-ND

Fred's car trunk smelled awful.



Smell-Desc

Fred's car trunk smelled like a gym locker stuffed with rotten eggs.



Sound-ND

The band was loud.



Sound-Desc

The band's ear splitting music was loud enough to make your teeth vibrate.





Rewrite the nondescriptive sentences by incorporating various sensory images.

Smell Details

The odor of Fred's gym shoes was awful.
The perfume smelled good.



Sound Details

My younger brother was loud.
The storm made a lot of noise.





Descriptive & Nondescriptive



Taste-ND

The bread tasted old.



Rewrite the nondescriptive sentences by incorporating various sensory images.

Taste Details

The breakfast pastries tasted good.

The chocolate cake was yummy.





Descriptive & Nondescriptive



Taste-ND

The bread tasted old.



Taste-Desc

The bread tasted mushy, like
some moldy cheese I ate at
my grandmother's house last
year.



Comparisons

Simile

Comparison using 'like' or 'as' to show similarity



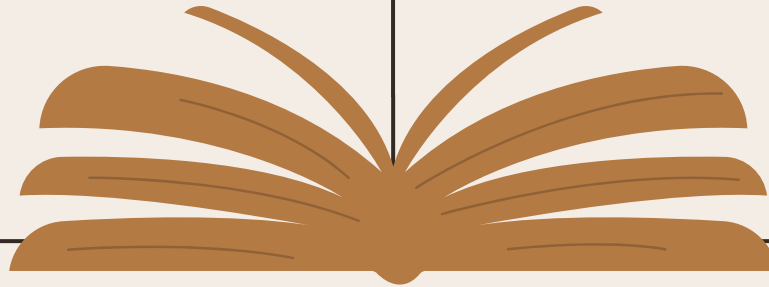
Metaphor

Stronger comparison without use of like or as. The implication that 'is' is same



Personification

Writer gives human emotions or characteristics to animals, objects or ideas.



Simile

Comparison using 'like' or 'as'

- My boss roars **like** a lion at his employees.
- The fog was **like** a blanket covering the city, so you couldn't see a thing.
- The runner was fast **as** a cheetah, and he won the race.
- The searchlight shined brightly **as** the sun, blocking our vision.





Metaphor

- My boss is a lion, roaring at his employees.
- The fog was a blanket covering the city, so you couldn't see a thing.
- She is an open book.

Personification

Writer gives human emotions or characteristics to animals, objects, or even ideas.

Lists like this one:

- The tree **howled** in the wind.
- The bear **cheated** his rivals out of their food.
- The house's windows **winked** at the passerby.
- The car **rested** in the driveway after the long drive home.





Activities



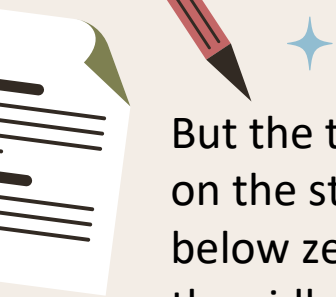


The spooky old houses come to life at night with gruesome decorations. With grotesque carved faces, the jack-o'-lanterns give off an eerie glow. Tombstones line the sidewalk, like a long narrow graveyard; beware of the bloody hand reaching out to grab intruders. Bats as black as the night sky fly in quick circles, darting in the air, and a black cat with razor sharp fangs crosses the path of unseen, terrified prey. The ghosts and the goblins sneak around monster-like trees, ready to snatch their next victim.



Questions:

- a. What is the topic?**
 - b. What do you think is the dominant impression the writer is attempting to create?**
 - c. Identify any figurative language techniques you find. How do they enhance the dominant impression.**
- 



But the true sound of deep cold is the sound of the wind. Monday morning, on the streets of Cambridge, Massachusetts, the windchill approached fifty below zero. A stiff northwest wind rocked in the trees and snatched at cars as they idled at the curb. A rough rime had settled over that old-brick city the day before, and now the wind was sanding it smooth. It was cold of Siberian or Antarctic intensity, and I could feel a kind of claustrophobia settling in all over Boston. People went about their errands, only to cut them short instantly, turning backs to the gust and fleeing for cover.



Questions:

- a. What is the topic?
 - b. What do you think is the dominant impression the writer is attempting to create?
 - c. Identify the two personifications used.
 - d. Is the tone of the paragraph objective or subjective?
 - e. Which specific nouns or adjectives does the writer use to create images?
- 

EXERCISE 1

Write a short story about a character who discovers a hidden talent. Explore the character's journey of self-discovery and how they overcome any obstacles along the way

Write your answer here...





EXERCISE 2



Choose 2 topics from this list and then combine them to create a creative writing!

Time travel

Your future self

The beauty
of nature

Deserted on
an island

Favorite writer

Hidden talent

Friendship

Difficult decision

Your past self

Different world

Power of
imagination

Personal challenge





Thank You!



